. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.
. Gulbadan Begum, *The History of Humayun*.
. Ibid.
. Jouher, *The Tezkereh al Vakiat*. Food was almost as precious as water on this journey. Jouher tells of how, as they were camped by a small lake on the border of Sindh and Rajasthan, a deer ran into the camp. The thought of a good meal spread a great delight through the company: 'What a delicious prize this deer would be!' cried Humayun as he got on his horse to hunt it. The deer ran into the water, and Jouher, showing both courage and a shrewd presence of mind, leaped in after it, calling out his condition, 'One quarter is mine.' Of course, Humayun agreed, and Jouher grabbed the deer and held on until it was killed.
. Ibid.
. Ibid.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1. Abul Fazl, delicately though scarcely credibly, ascribes the plunder to Rana Prasad and applauds the 'perfect kindness, liberality and justice' by which Humayun kept only a small portion of this loot for his staff and returned 'the bulk of it to [its] low-minded, narrow-souled owners'. Gulbadan, meanwhile, writes that Humayun had to borrow 80,000 ashrafis (gold coins) from Tardi Beg who, unsurprisingly, stipulated a callous 20 per cent rate of interest on the loan.
. Gulbadan Begum, *The History of Humayun*.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.
. Shah Husain's own father, meanwhile, had lost Qandahar to Babur – one reason why Shah Husain was so disinclined to help Babur's son.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.
. As explained by Henry Beveridge in *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.
. The three paragraphs from 'Once Humayun became emperor' to 'a successor in turn' are extracted, with some modification, from an article I wrote for *The Hindu Businessline*, 'Gulbadan Begum's story', published 21 June 2019.
. Chagatais were descendants of Chinghis Khan's second son, Chagatai. Babur was a Chagatai, too, on his mother's side, and a Timurid – a descendant of Timur – on his father's. Many writers and historians consider this something of a genealogical jackpot for Babur and his progeny, combining as it did both Mongol (Chinghizid) and Turkish (Timurid) nobility in their veins. The view is not unchallenged. More on this later.
. Gulbadan Begum, *The History of Humayun*.
. Jiji was the first anaka to hold Akbar, but not the first to nurse him. She had not delivered her own son yet, so had no milk to give. A substitute nurse and servant of Humayun's, Daya Bhawal, was ordered to take her place and became, therefore, Akbar's first wet nurse.